Margin

A manuscript on a desk. Content reads like a book; the editor's notes live in the margin.

Margin notes sit here, beside the line they concern.

Design system for the adventure platform

A plain, minimal interface for a product that is mostly a document editor: the adventure editor, the campaign editor, the character editor, and the play log.

Content is a page.

Every editable thing is set like a page of a book: a centred column, Literata, generous leading. Chrome sits on the desk around it.

Notes belong in the margin.

Validation messages, comments, and the trace appear in a right-hand margin beside the line they concern, like an editor's pencil notes. The text itself is never obscured.

Two typefaces, two jobs.

Literata sets what the author wrote and what the narrator says. Atkinson Hyperlegible sets every control, label, and number the software owns.

Colour

Ten tokens. Colour carries meaning only: action, selection, and status. Contrast is measured against the page colour; text tokens meet WCAG AA at body size.

Page

#FFFFFF page

1.0:1 on page, surface only

Document surfaces, panels, inputs

Desk

#EEF0F3 desk

1.1:1 on page, surface only

Application background behind pages; disabled fills

Ink

#1E2330 ink

15.7:1 on page, AA text

Body text, headings, icons

Graphite

#596070 muted

6.3:1 on page, AA text

Secondary text, placeholders, metadata

Rule

#D5D9E0 rule

1.4:1 on page, surface only

Borders, dividers, input outlines

Fountain ink

#2945A8 accent

8.4:1 on page, AA text

Primary actions, links, focus, selection

Ink wash

#E8EDFB accent_soft

1.2:1 on page, surface only

Selected rows, active tab ground

Correction

#A8261C danger

7.1:1 on page, AA text

Errors, destructive actions, margin notes

Settled

#2C7046 success

6.0:1 on page, AA text

Saved, valid, published

Query

#7E5A00 warning

6.3:1 on page, AA text

Warnings that do not block publishing

Pairings

Aa	Aa	Aa	Aa	Aa	Aa
15.7:1	6.3:1	8.4:1	8.4:1	7.1:1	13.4:1

Typography

Literata for prose and headings; Atkinson Hyperlegible for interface text. Sizes follow a 1.2 ratio from a 14 px control size. Sentence case everywhere; no capitals or letter-spacing for labels.

Display 28/34 px	The Sunken Archive	Section titles on documents and the play log
Heading 19/25 px	Find the core	Record titles: an arc, a room, an NPC
Prose 15/24 px	The lift hums awake. Somewhere below, water moves against the archive doors, patient as it has been for forty years.	Narration, briefs, room text; max 66 characters
Prose small 13/20 px	The lift hums awake. Somewhere below, water moves against the archive doors, patient as it has been for forty years.	Trigger narration, topic briefs in cards
Control 14/20 px	Save changes	Buttons, inputs, menus, tabs
Label 12.5/18 px	**Starting room**	Field labels, column headers; sentence case
Caption 11.5/16 px	Saved 2 minutes ago	Hints, metadata, margin notes

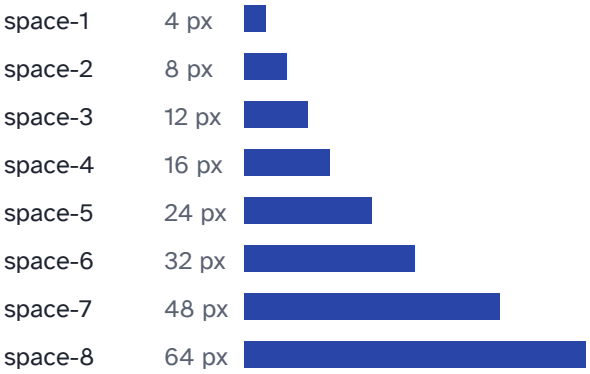
Measure

Prose columns are 34rem (about 66 characters) wide. Forms are 36rem. Tables and canvases use the full workspace width. Text is left-aligned; nothing is justified or centred except empty-state messages.

Space, shape, and depth

A 4 px base. Panels are separated by space and a single rule, never by shadows stacked on cards.

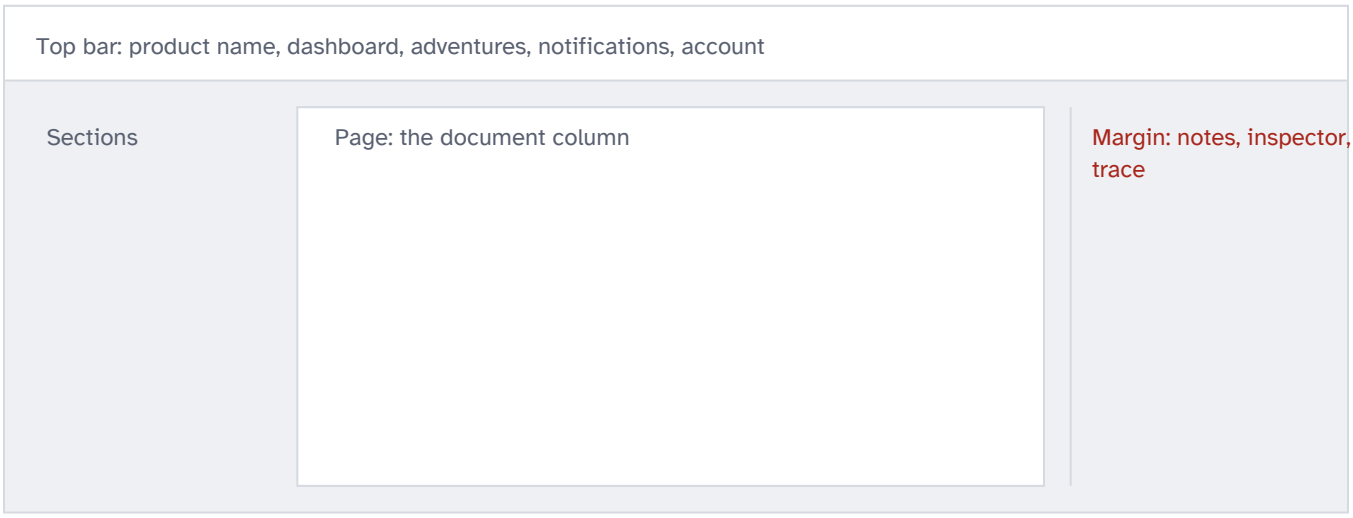
Spacing scale



Shape

Radius	3 px on controls and cards; 0 on pages, panels, and canvases; full on avatars and status dots.
Borders	1 px Rule on inputs, cards, and panel edges. 2 px Fountain ink for focus.
Depth	One raised level, for menus and dialogs only: 1 px border plus a 0 8 24 shadow at 12% ink. Pages sit on the desk with a 1 px rule and no shadow.
Focus	2 px ring in the accent, 2 px offset, on every interactive element. Never removed.
Motion	120 ms ease-out for opening menus and panels. Nothing moves on page load. Reduced-motion users get instant changes.

Application frame



Components

Controls share one height (30 px small, 36 px default), one radius, and one focus ring.

Buttons

Publish Export Add trigger Delete arc

One primary button per view. The label names the action, and the confirmation repeats it: Publish, then Published.

Fields and validation

Starting room

airlock

Players arrive here when an instance starts.

Requires

reactor_cor

Unknown item
reactor_cor is not in this adventure or its settings.

Pickers and tabs

Archivist Oyelaran the power core Find the core: searching

Details Materials Members Invitations

Pickers show labels, never ids. A selected reference reads as a filled token in the accent wash. Tabs mark the active tab with a 2 px accent underline.

Status

Active Paused Lobby Ended 2 problems

Status is a dot plus a word, so it never depends on colour alone.

Rule card

Hear about the core — Only once

When a player talks to Archivist about the power core

If arc Find the core is at inactive

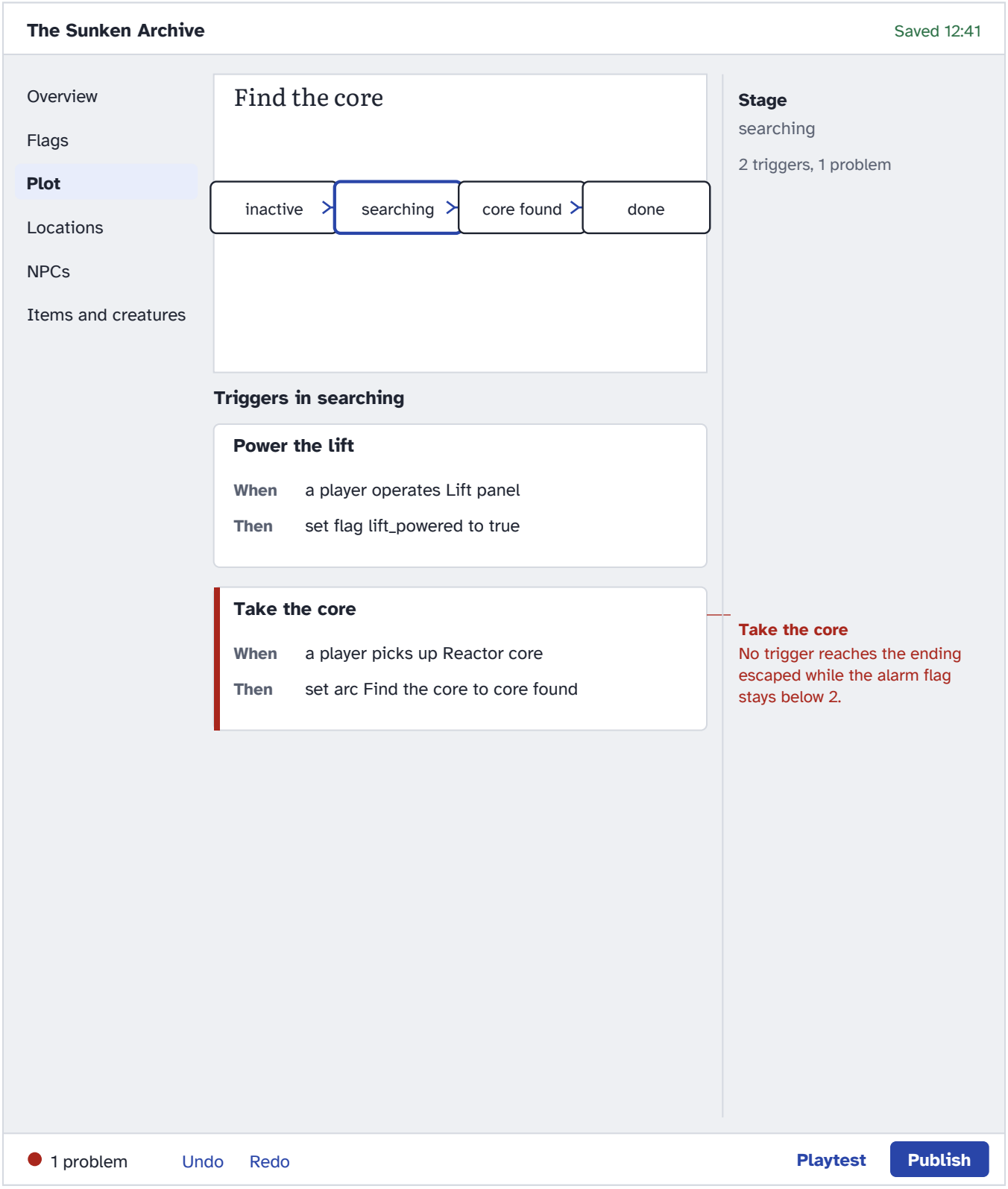
Then set arc Find the core to searching

Narrate *The archivist points toward the lift.*

Asking the Archivist about the core starts the search.

Screen: adventure editor

The Plot section with an arc selected. Sketch at 50% scale.



Screen: play

A running instance. The log is a page of prose; the software's state sits beside it.

Round 4, everyone acts Waiting on Rook, 1:42 left

You: smash the drone with my wrench

The wrench dents the drone's housing. It staggers, sparks crawling over its arm, and the swing pulls hard at your grip.

Rolled 8, tough choice · Drone: 2 HP left

Rook: check the control panel

The panel wakes under Rook's keycard. Somewhere behind the bulkhead, a lift begins to climb.

Lift gate opened

Success, at a cost. Choose a setback:

Strain yourself: lose 1 HP | **Drop the wrench**

Choose a setback to continue

Vale, spy

7/10 HP

8 AP

Heavy wrench, medkit

Hangar

Inner door, west

Lift, sealed

Maintenance drone, far

Party

Rook, declared

Ash, waiting

Tailwind tokens

Add to the theme in app/globals.css (Tailwind v4 @theme). Utilities follow:
bg-page, text-ink, border-rule, ring-accent, font-prose, font-ui.

```
@theme {
  --color-page: #FFFFFF;
  --color-desk: #EEF0F3;
  --color-ink: #1E2330;
  --color-muted: #596070;
  --color-rule: #D5D9E0;
  --color-accent: #2945A8;
  --color-accent-soft: #E8EDFB;
  --color-danger: #A8261C;
  --color-danger-soft: #FBECEA;
  --color-success: #2C7046;
  --color-warning: #7E5A00;
  --font-prose: "Literata", Georgia, serif;
  --font-ui: "Atkinson Hyperlegible", system-ui, sans-serif;
  --radius-control: 3px;
  --spacing: 4px;
  --text-control: 14px;  --text-control--line-height: 20px;
  --text-prose: 15px;    --text-prose--line-height: 24px;
}
```

Fonts

Literata and Atkinson Hyperlegible, both SIL Open Font License, loaded with next/font/google.